

The Tantra-Ritual of the Noble Vajra Chain

Ārya-vajra-śṛṅkhalā-tantra-kalpa · Toh 758 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་མ་རྩོམ་སྐུ་གཟིང་ཀུན་ལྷོ་པ།

Toh 758 in the Kangyur is a tantric text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-vajra-śṛṅkhalā-tantra-kalpa and in Tibetan as the Tantra-Ritual of the Noble Vajra Chain Tantra. It belongs to the class of tantric ritual literature and concerns the practice of the Noble Vajra Chain, a deity associated with liberation from bondage, the dispelling of suffering, and the cultivation of qualities such as faith, compassion, and disciplined wisdom. The text takes the form of instructional verse, guiding practitioners through ritual observance and the recitation of secret mantra, emphasizing the indispensability of the teacher and the proper orientation of mind. It was translated into Tibetan by the great translator Bandhe Yeshe De and his colleagues, and subsequently revised and finalized in the careful editorial tradition of the early translation period.

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In the language of India: Ārya-vajra-śṛṅkhalā-tantra-kalpa. In the Tibetan language: The Tantra-Ritual of the Noble Vajra Chain Tantra.

Homage to the Glorious Lord of the World.

Now, what is to be correctly taught:
Listen well to the beautiful ritual
that generates splendor, dispels suffering,
and frees one from the bonds of hatred's assemblage.

Without bathing and purification,
having fully abandoned the practice of asceticism,
this secret mantra, recited
with a fierce and forceful mind, swiftly accomplishes.

Adorned with faith and joyous effort,
endowed with great heedfulness and compassion,
one who does not abandon the teacher
is greatly pleased by brave and disciplined wisdom.

One who has loving-kindness toward all beings —
through merely beginning mantra, meditative absorption, mudrā, and the rest,

accomplishment arises.

One who lacks faith, is lazy, and given to harm,
who is not devoted to the teacher,
whose wisdom is weak and whose strength is small,
who is heedless and bears ill-will toward others —
even if, upon receiving a lofty empowerment,
such a one were to strive for thousands of eons,
accomplishing it ten million times over,
there would be no fruit.

It is just as when some foolish children,
desiring fruit, beat the seedling stalk:
from sheer exhaustion alone,
fruit will never come.

This great king of secret mantras, supreme among mantra-kings,
is the source of many kinds of blessing.

Then the Blessed One of Great Bliss,
known as "Certain Accomplishment,"
entered into meditative absorption, and from his own unsurpassed vajra body,
speech, and mind
this mantra-king was drawn forth.

Homage to the Bhagavatī Vajra-śṛṅkhalā. Hana hana. Dara dara. Cchinda cchinda. Bhañja bhañja. Māraya māraya. Vasayatini. Rakta-akṣī vajra-ghoṇī. Homage to the Bhagavatī Vajra-śṛṅkhalā. In the eastern direction, bind with a vajra enclosure. In the southern direction, bind with a staff enclosure. In the western direction, bind with a water enclosure. In the northern direction, bind with a snake enclosure. In the direction of fire, bind with a fire enclosure. In the direction of Nirṛti, bind with a sword enclosure. In the direction of Vāyu, bind with a wind enclosure. In the direction of Īśāna, bind with a trident enclosure. In the direction of Vātāla, bind with a nāga noose. In the direction of Uratha, bind with a vajra-śṛṅkhalā enclosure. Bind above. Hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

This Vajra-śṛṅkhalā: bind in the ten directions of the maṇḍala. Bind with indestructible protection. Bind the brahma-rākṣasa and those like them. Bind the wandering spirits (bhūta), the hungry ghosts (preta), and the flesh-eating demons (piśāci). Bind the gandharva. Bind the gandharva clan. Bind

Sanatkumāra. Bind Santakumāra and his realm. Bind the knowledge-holders (vidyādhara). Bind Mākaṃ the ascetic. Bind the nāga-ascetic realm — bind in the maṇḍala. Bind all the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) — bind in the maṇḍala. Bind the lion, bind the tiger. Bind the yakṣiṇī. Bind the Dākṣa assembly. Bind the destroyer. Bind the Kaṭaṇṭaka. Bind the sky-traveler (khecara). Bind the Śakunī. Bind the lamp-demon. Bind the lamp-demon clan. Bind the nāga. Bind the asura. Bind the asura clan. Bind the garuḍa. Bind the garuḍa clan. Bind the birds. Bind the bird multitude. Bind the kiṃnara. Bind the kiṃnara realm. Bind humans. Bind the human realm. Bind the non-humans. Bind the non-human realm. Bind the realms of the moon and sun. Bind all of them. Bind all levels of all. Bind trees. Bind the tree roots. Bind the own clan. Bind the enemy clan. Bind the maṇḍaka. Bind the maśāpa. Bind what has been bound temporarily. Bind permanently. Bind all malevolent beings. Vajra-śṛṅkhalā: bind with the maṇḍa. Bind Kubera. Bind together with the makara (sea-monster). Bind the Śrī-sumara. Bind water. Bind land. Oṃ, homage to the Bhagavatī Vajra-śṛṅkhalā.

Hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Bind all malevolent ones, bind all who move about. To the twelve-armed one. To the twelve-eyed one. To her of the streaming hair. To the fierce one. To her blazing with a thousand flames, radiant as a lamp. To her who bears manifold fierce forms. To her with upward-streaming hair. To the trembling one. Bind those hostile to the Tathāgata. This Vajra-śṛṅkhalā — by her mantra, bind within a circle of twenty-five yojanas. Bind with the Vajra-śṛṅkhalā. Sever the armour-seal and bind the nega-tree. Bind the udrayana. Bind the four ḍākinīs. Tiṣṭha tiṣṭha, hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ, phaṭ, svāhā. Hulu hulu. Homage to Caṇḍa, the Great Wrathful One. Hu hu, amṛta, hu hu, bind. Eighty million koṭis of hundreds of thousands of divine vajra-śṛṅkhalā — bind. Shatter the summit of the triangular earth with the vajra. The three-toned wind, the bātāla, the vāsuki — stir them up. Bind the wind. Bind the clouds. Bind everywhere. Bind Indra. Bind Indra. Bind the realm of Indra. Bind the lord of the forest. Bind the deity of the forest. Bind the one-footed. Bind the two-footed. Bind the three-footed. Bind the four-footed. Bind the five-footed. Bind the hundred-footed. Bind the hundred-thousand-footed. Bind all obstacles. Bind all families of obstacles. Bind Brahmā. Bind the realm of Brahmā. Bind Viṣṇu. Bind the realm of Viṣṇu. Bind Maheśvara. Bind the realm of Maheśvara. Bind the Great God. Stride and overpower the Great God (Śiva) with the foot of Mahādeva. Oṃ, homage to the Bhagavatī Vajra-śṛṅkhalā — bind in the ten directions with the vajra-enclosure.

Hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ, svāhā.

The very moment this vidyā-mantra was proclaimed,
these vast world-systems
trembled in six ways,
and gods, asuras, rākṣasas,
yakṣas, gandharvas, and nāgas,
garuḍas, serpents, and decomposing corpses,
nāgas, kiṃnaras, and the rest —
all those hosts fell into a stupor
and collapsed face-downward on the ground,
their senses utterly lost.

The very instant the rays of great bliss touched them,
they regained consciousness and their splendour was reborn.
Then they praised her with the king of praises:

How wondrous! From the glorious supreme great bliss itself,
through the auspiciousness born of flourishing power,
by the mere utterance of Hūṃ by the goddess,
it resounds through the expanse of space.
Sovereign of primordial wisdom of great bliss,
the goddess who bears the name of Vajra,
who is like an unbroken rosary —
we bow to her with reverence.

By the rays of diverse colours from her body,
which dispel the afflictions of wandering beings,
bliss arose in me through that light.

O goddess of bliss, to you we bow.

Aspirant of emptiness, free from characteristics,
from the vidyā of all the Victors,
the wondrous goddess's nature of mind —
free from conceptual thought, her intrinsic nature — to that we bow.

Thereupon the vidyā-goddess who embodies all the Victors in form and the
rest,
having made fine offerings at this maṇḍala
and gathering with one voice together,
praised her with vajra-words as proclaimed by the buddhas:

To the vajra born from space,
the mother who gives birth to all buddhas,
luminous in nature as space free from conceptual elaboration —
to the vajra mind we bow.

With the sound of the vajra form
she binds without exception all the hosts of gods.

The vajra sound that cuts down all māras —
to that voice in space we bow.

She who subdues the māras of the six classes of beings, the six-faced one,
who bows for the sake of pure outer and inner dependent origination,
graceful and yet inspiring slight awe —
to her vajra body we bow.

With those words all the gods and the rest
praised the vajra goddess
with that wondrous king of praises,
and the very instant she was praised,
the goddess arose with great resplendent majesty
and proclaimed her own heart-essence:

Oṃ Vajra-śṛṅkhalā Hūṃ Hūṃ Phaṭ Svāhā.

By the mere recitation of this garland of vidyā-dhāraṇī,
this very secret mantra,

epidemics and swellings, skin diseases,
leprosy, mottled flesh, tumors born of that affliction,
brain disease, eye disease, ear disease,
diseases of the internal organs, lung and liver complaints,
stabbing pains in the joints, heart disease, kidney disease,
disease of the limbs, and pervasive illness,
lymphatic disorders and diseases of the blood,
phlegm, wind, and bile,
and diseases arising from severe imbalance of humors —
all epidemic diseases without exception it pacifies.

Furthermore, the oblivion-casting spirits that cause forgetfulness,
the flesh-eating ḍākinīs and demonesses,
malefic planetary powers and wandering stars that lead astray,
fierce harmful sorcery and binding spells,
the fierce vidyā-mantras of outsiders, and all the rest —

every terrifying harm of every kind
it scatters like clouds before the wind.

Furthermore, tigers, leopards, bears, brown bears,
leaping creatures, great wolves,
hares, rats, snakes, mice,
insects, long-beaked creatures, scorpions,
crows, owls, horses and the like —
however many and various the terrors may be,
by the mere recitation and hearing of this secret mantra
they are driven far away.

All harms of every variety
are cleared by the application of this mantra.

Those who do harm are rendered harmless,
and the harmless are brought to bear harm as well;
a binding application, too, is itself bound by another's application,
and another's binding is itself fettered.

This concludes the first chapter of the Vajra Chain Tantra, the chapter teaching
the secret mantra from the Meditations of that Tantra.

Now here is what is to be explained.

The beautiful vajra wrathful goddess declares:

Listen with the great bindu to the divine meditative absorption practices.

Oṃ Vajra-śṛṅkhale

Ātma-rakṣa rakṣa

Hūṃ Hūṃ Hūṃ Phaṭ Svāhā.

With this secret mantra one is protected,
and the body is purified of ordinary conceptual thinking.
From a Hūṃ syllable standing on a moon disc at the heart,
rays of light stream forth;
the sovereign lady of one's lineage
and the lama buddha are invited
and clearly visualized before one.

From the light-rays at the tip of the seed-syllable at the heart,
goddess-attendants holding flowers and the like make offerings;
the vajra goddesses of form and the other senses
bow down and each makes excellent offering in turn.

From throughout the beginningless stream of existence,
all the masses of evil deeds
performed by body, speech, and mind
without exception and in their entirety —
those one did oneself, those one caused others to do,
and those in which one rejoiced after they were done —
all of these, every last one, throughout all existences,
I confess individually.

And the extensive vow never to commit them again
I now take upon myself.

I rejoice in the deeds of the Victors together with their bodhisattva heirs,
and in the virtue of all migrating beings.
In the Victors, the bodhisattvas,
the noble vajra goddesses of the lineage,
and the vast wheel of the mantra tantras,
I take refuge with complete and wholehearted devotion.

I beseech you: in order to give rise to non-conceptual wisdom,
please turn the wheel of Dharma,
and do not pass into nirvāṇa
until all those to be tamed are fully satisfied.

The awakening mind supreme in all its aspects
I shall now arouse.

From the very beginning until the present moment,
whatever this body has failed to do —
now, understanding the wind of conditioned existence,
I offer up this very body of mine.

The vast ocean of the supreme and unsurpassable path of the Great Vehicle —
until the fruit of the Great Vehicle is attained,
I shall rely upon it without interruption.

In this way, having applied faith and aspiration
and having accumulated vast stores of merit,
all that virtue, unsurpassed,
I dedicate entirely to awakening.

First, with rays of loving-kindness,
establish all beings in happiness.
Second, with rays of compassion,

arouse the intention to free beings from suffering.

Third, with joy, may they obtain bliss.

Fourth, free from attachment, rest in equanimity.

After that, abandoning the power of coarseness
and clearing away the stains of habitual tendencies,
one then recollects purity
in the manner of practicing like space.

Oṃ Svabhāvaśuddhāḥ sarvadharmāḥ svabhāvaśuddho 'haṃ Hūṃ.

Having been purified by that,
emptiness is then to be meditated upon in sequence.

Oṃ Śūnyatājñānavajrasvabhāvātmako 'haṃ.

All phenomena without exception
are to be meditated upon as like space.

Within that, from the syllable Raṃ arises a solar maṇḍala,
red, blazing with clustered rays — meditate on this.

In its center, from the blue syllable Hūṃ,
light rays drive away the māras of beings,
and then the light is drawn back into the syllable:
the Vajra Wrathful One appears in full perfection —
three faces, six arms, abiding in a mass of fire.
At her heart, on a sun disc, visualize the blue Hūṃ;
by its light, create the protection wheel.

To the east, a vajra; to the south, a sword;
to the west, water; to the north, an arrow.

To the northeast, a three-pointed spear; to the southeast, fire;
to the southwest, a sword; to the northwest, wind.

Below, a crossed vajra of many kinds;
above, a pavilion capped with a five-pointed vajra.

Through the recitation of the secret mantra, this is to be meditated upon.

From Hūṃ, rays of light radiate forth,
and on the outer perimeter of the arranged wheel,
a three-pointed vajra fence
and a pavilion are to be perfectly meditated upon.

After that, the Vajra Wrathful One
dissolves and becomes devoid of inherent existence.
From that, resting upon a sun disc,
the four mārās are suppressed, and the sun and moon
arise from the vowels and consonants (Ālikāli).
In the middle, from Hūṃ arises a vajra,
encircled by light in the nature of the Wrathful One.
The Wrathful One together with her retinue of light rays
abides within the vajra; the form arises —
six faces, six arms, and six feet,
or else four feet, suppressing the four mārās.
All her faces are blue and frowning with wrathful brows;
her hair, reddish-gold, streams upward; she is adorned with a skull garland.
Her body is ornamented with vajras, the color of the sky.
She has twelve arms. In the right hands
she holds a vajra, a lasso, a nocked arrow,
a snake, a war-axe, a curved blade.
In the left hands: a bell, a threatening finger gesture, a bow,
a club, a three-pointed hammer.

Alternatively, with six arms: the first right hand holds a vajra,
the second, iron chains,
the third draws an arrow;
the first left hand makes the threatening finger gesture,
the second holds a snake lasso,
the third holds a bow in a drawing posture.

The Vajra Chain Tantra (vajraśṛṅkhala) teaches:
when one rests in meditative concentration and samādhi,
one becomes the very identity of all qualities —
the root of all mantras.

Fully arousing the identity of mantra
and accomplishing the inherent nature of the deity,
through the garland of the precious dhāraṇī
all phenomena will be fully obtained:
the sword, the eye-ointment, the pill,
the foot-anointing, the great treasure,
traveling under the earth, extraction of essence,
traveling through the sky, transmutation into gold,

likewise traveling to other lands,
pacification, enrichment, magnetizing, and subjugation,
stupefaction, paralysis, expulsion,
separation, summoning, binding of vidyā mantras,
protection and great reversal,
making mute, making dumb, causing unconsciousness,
causing blindness, and bringing about various diseases —
the accomplishment of these vast ritual activities,
the full arising of the six kinds of direct knowledge,
and the attainment of the great seal (mahāmudrā) of the vajra of body,
speech, and mind:
of what need is it to speak of the minor siddhis,
such as merely seeing auspicious signs?

The deity produced by the practice of mantra,
who has become the very root of visualization —
the goddess born from Hūṃ:
blue, three-faced, six-armed;
the right face yellow, the left face red;
three eyes, gazing with wrathful, angry eyes,
frowning with wrath;
adorned with reddish-gold upswept hair and skulls;
ornamented and resplendent with bone ornaments;
garlanded with a skull necklace, adorned with snakes;
two feet, one extended and one drawn in, stamping upon a corpse.
In the six hands — first right holds a vajra,
second a curved blade,
third holds a snake lasso;
first left makes the threatening finger gesture,
second holds a skull,
third holds a white snake lasso.

Alternatively, all faces are blue.
By means of this deity, all activities of binding and of magnetizing
are brought to complete accomplishment.
In existence, the brahmin-born goddess —

Blue, one face, two hands.

The right hand holds a vajra, the left an iron chain.

Naked, adorned with bone ornaments.

All activities of slaying

are brought to complete accomplishment by this Vajrayoginī.

Then the Blessed One, the Vajra-Bearer,

entered into meditative absorption in the samādhi

called "Mudrā Arising, which causes all phenomena to arise

and swiftly generates siddhis,"

and declared the auxiliary mudrās.

Join the two hands in añjali, palms pressed together,

then fold them back into fists,

bring the two backs of the hands together, and bind

the index fingers and little fingers with an iron-chain grip.

Hold them level before the mouth,

and by reciting the vidyā rosary,

all desires are fulfilled.

With this mudrā sealed, merely by mentally recalling the secret mantra,
one travels the road in ease and is liberated.

It also severs the mantras of others.

This concludes the second chapter of the tantra of the Noble Vajra Chain
Tantra — the chapter establishing the deities and mudrās from the
vidyāmantra.

Then, what is to be correctly taught —

the supreme union of substances,

which accomplishes all that is comparable to it —

let the Vajra Ḍākinī hear:

Oṃ sarva tathāgata abhiṣiñcatu mām. Oṃ sarva tathāgata abhiṣekata samaya
śriye hūṃ.

Empowerment is supreme beyond all others.

It purifies the mass of defilements,

and for as long as it is needed, until the accumulation of wisdom has grown
vast,

one attains the king of vidyās.

Jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ. Oṃ vajra puṣpe āḥ hūṃ svāhā. Dhūpe dīpe gandhe.
Naivedye āḥ hūṃ svāhā. Oṃ kṣī hrīḥ skala. Ghaṇa vina vare. Śyarya
saparivrāra a a a. Abhitiranti. Abhitarante. Abhitarantu. Satha daśa dik.
Lokapāla. Lokapāli. Emaṃ pāliḡṛhṇantu. Khādantu pibantu hūṃ phaṭ. Kha kha
khāhi khāhi. Llai llai vajra dharaya. Ājñāvayati svāhā.

Through the union with the wisdom being (jñānasattva),
dualistic conceptuality is abandoned.

Through offerings and torma (ritual cake offerings),
all interruptions and obstacles are completely cleared away.

Oṃ kāya vajra svabhāva ātmako 'ham.

By the vajra of body, speech, and mind,
one ornamented with marks that are thoroughly adorned —
knowing that those without marks abide within those marks —
the characteristics are thoroughly purified.

Oṃ sarva tathāgata jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako 'ham.

That which is indicated by the sense faculties as object,
the indicated, the characteristic, consciousness,
and gnosis itself directly —
concerning the arising of these, there is no doubt.

Then the chief of the great unions —
the ritual of the cakra — shall be explained.

On a piece of coarse cloth or on bark,
write with saffron, civet, and sandalwood:
a cakra of ten spokes upon a lotus, drawn in yellow pukka,
encircled at the periphery by a garland of fire.

On the ten petals of the lotus,
write the ten — vajra and so forth — that bind in all ten directions.

On the back of each of these, write in sequence the binding mantras for each
of the ten directions.

On the ten spokes of the cakra,
write the name of the one to be accomplished, enclosed between two hūṃs,
together with the protective mantra.

In the four directions, write the mantras, mudrās, and the yantra for cutting,
binding, and magnetizing.

Furthermore, at the six intermediate directions,

write the six bindings — for gods, nāgas, asuras,
yakṣas, piśācas, and so forth.

At the center, draw an image of the one to be accomplished,
seated in cross-legged posture, hands joined in añjali at the heart,
wearing beautiful garments.

Then recite the mantra rosary one thousand times.

After that, praise with hymns of praise.

Melt together gold and so forth, and apply it to the body or throat,
or wherever one pleases to place it.

By this, for the protection of the yogin,
all that one wishes is accomplished,
and the eight fears are eliminated.

Then furthermore, the king's cloth —

With gold, sandalwood, camphor,
and fragrant substances, prepare it,
then on the day of the lunar mansion Revatī,
draw a wheel with saffron.

At the center, on the pericarp of a lotus with eight petals
enclosed by three outer borders,
draw the form of the one to be accomplished,
marked with the vajra of the limbs.

Surround it with the mantra of the heart essence.

Then, on the border around the hub,
write the binding mantras of above and below.

The mantras of the directions and intermediate directions go on the petals.

On the first outer border,
arrange the long root mantra.

On the second, draw a fence of light.

Place fragrance upon the maṇḍala,
and complete the yogic union with the deity as oneself.

From the seed at the heart, with rays of light,
purify the wheel in the sky;

visualize it in the form of the syllable HŪṂ.

From its total transformation, meditate on the assembled bodies.

At the center, visualize wisdom:
above a moon disk, from HŪṂ,

meditate on a wheel with spokes.

There, the form of the syllable —
visualize it clearly, like a lamp flame —
becomes inseparable from the ḍākinī.

Recite the secret mantra one thousand times,
arising from the seed in one's own heart.

Then melt gold and so forth, and if it is fastened to the body or throat,
it protects from the eight fears
and is certain to guard in all circumstances.

With the five kinds of white mustard
together with stalks of dūrvā grass,
recite the secret mantra one thousand times,
and by applying them through the ritual of the nameless old woman,
making drops at the three places and protecting with them,
life will increase a thousandfold many times over.

With kuśa grass, clarified butter, white mustard, and sesame,
recite the secret mantra one thousand times,
and on an auspicious day
place it on the crown of a stūpa:
epidemic diseases that have taken hold will cease.

In blood and bile,
recite the secret mantra three thousand times,
at the time of a lunar eclipse,
completing the close approach practice.
Apply the substance very finely,
then press the mantra into the heart
of whatever assembly of gods one has in mind as the target of harm:
whatever obstacle one aims at will be utterly destroyed.

On fresh new woolen cloth,
having washed it with wisdom-marked water,
and placed it on an auspicious day,
tie knots in the number of the bindings,
then recite the mantra one thousand times
and fasten it to the body, throat, or crown of the head.
By this one can withstand a thousand years of life,

and epidemic illness will not harm even slightly.

Clothing, food, vessels and utensils,
medicine, and other substances —
if protected with the unshaken seal of the king,
nothing whatsoever can cause harm.

If one speaks three owl-cries
in the manner of a great lion's roar,
even a thousand vidyā-mantras of outsiders
will be utterly unable to prevail.

Remaining in the natural mode of the king of nāgas,
with one-pointed mind and the vajra mudrā,
then reciting the secret mantra three times,
illnesses, spirit afflictions, and the like are cleared away.

Making the boundary of the rabbit's nipple,
with the mantra sealed by HŪṂ,
with a mind settled in objectless meditative absorption —
by this too one will be protected from harm.

Abandoning all externals and the like,
train the mind on appearances,
and clearly focus on the non-apparent:
this is declared the supreme of all protections.

Then yet further practices are described.
In charnel grounds and other frightening places,
or beside a lake, a pond, a hermitage,
a sacred site, a great pleasure grove,
a flower garden, a country region,
the bank of a river, a single tree,
or indeed in one's own home —
on a surface well smeared with maṇḍala,
relying on that, accomplish the yogic union with the deity.
With cloth painting and the like set before one,
seated cross-legged on a comfortable seat,
enter into meditative equipoise.
With a body trained in the ordinary way —

one attains the great liberation — otherwise, it is not so.

On a mountain whose ground is exceedingly delightful and well adorned, in a grove of most beautiful forest, in a place where cool streams flow down, within a carefully arranged bower of flowers, in a dwelling whose door faces east, whose corners are bound with the four mantras according to the rite, that is built in a place equipped with windows — where sweet-voiced birds cry out, where fragrant incense drifts its scent, where bells ring with a lovely tinkling sound, and which is encircled with garlands of rustling silken banners — having abandoned all excessive social activity, together with companions whose conduct is harmonious, one should joyfully accomplish awakening.

Yet the place, companions, and so forth are taken up only to draw the yogi's mind in; beyond all these, when they are entirely abandoned, there is no higher awakening. All the varied experiences of pleasure and suffering arise from one's own mind — this I will not deny — yet from the complete abandonment of mind and its conceptual thoughts, I have taught no other Dharma whatsoever. Therefore, in order to abandon the various workings of mind and conceptual thought, various methods have been taught: mantras, mudrās, meditative absorptions, and the great range of practices.

As for some of the methods for accomplishing wrathful action — attend to them through the wrathful wisdom goddess. Anoint the ground with the five nectars. Draw on it a charnel-ground leaf with a fire maṇḍala and its seed syllables. Then, on a skull of either male or female, apply red-and-black pigment on the outside. On the inside, draw various vajras, each with three rings. In the center, write the heart-mantra of the Vajra Ḍākinī with its mantra. On every prong of the vajras, write HŪṂ; on the second ring, write a garland mantra; and on the third, write the mantra of the wrathful deity. Place inside the joined skulls: the juice of bhallātaka, white mustard, strong poison, salt, blood, great flesh, footprint-soil, and the like. The yogi, naked and with hair unbound, in the absorption of the deity, facing south, presses the skull-wheel with the foot and recites the mantra garland. When, from meditative equipoise in the practice of the Great Wrathful One, one recites by night for a thousand repetitions, there is no doubt the target will be slain.

Now draw a wheel on charnel-ground cloth, with a fire maṇḍala in the center, eight spokes, and three rings. In the center, along with the heart-mantra, write a second HŪṂ followed by the name of the target along with the word "slain." The second ring's garland mantra likewise contains the name and the word

"slain." The third ring bears the mantra of the wrathful deity. Worship the wheel, consecrate it with blessing, and insert a figure of the enemy eight finger-widths in size into the breast. Anoint that same figure with sesame oil, place it between the two skull-wheels, and set it over fire. Place a khadira-wood phurba eight finger-widths long there, and with the practice of meditative equipoise apply the mantra to it. Through this very practice of slaying, death will come — in no other way.

Alternatively, from the limb of awakening: draw the wheel in charnel-ground blood. Draw a figure constructed of three gus stacked together. In the center, write the enemy's name along with the secret mantra. On the twelve intervals of the spokes, write the name along with the word "slain." The mantra garland of the first ring should also be written together with the elaborating limbs. Insert a monkey-fat effigy eight finger-widths in size into the breast and bind it with hair. Then place it so that the head of the sleeping yogi faces south. Recite the mantra twenty-one times until it cannot be seen in the crystal mirror. Adorned with a strip of human-vajra cloth, the enemy will not remain on this earth.

In a place known as the abode of nāgas, or on the bank of a water pool and the like, anoint it with the fivefold maṇḍala substances. In the design of a red lotus, at the navel: the Vajra Ḍākinī, golden in color, with palms joined, wearing a nāga crown of seven coils, dwelling upon a moon-disc — gaze upon her steadily and remain there. Make forms of the Joyful, the Very Joyful, the Steadfast, the Boundless, the Conch-Keeper, and the Lineage-Holder — also the Padma and the great Padma — in white, yellow, and green,

in red, pale green, pale blue, red-yellow, and green-yellow, each smiling in form. Bowing with palms joined to the chief deity, dwell in a place adorned with a garland of stars. Milk, rice, kidney fat, sour milk, and flesh, along with puṣkara, sesame, and other medicinal substances, together with the bundle-carrier and its accompaniments — these are to be spread out in a jeweled vessel.

May the planets and stars be gladdened,
may the nāgas attain a mind of happiness,
may the gods, their minds settled in equanimity,
give rise to a great intelligence of compassion.

May gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, and the rest,
endowed with a great awakening mind,

and holding compassion close in their heart,
cause a great rain to fall in its season.

Following that aspiration prayer, recite one hundred and eight strands of dhāraṇī — the moment they are recited, streams of rain will also fall. If the rain does not come even a little, then by merely threatening with fire and scattering a garland of lightning, there is no doubt that it will cause a great rain to fall.

With fox blood, draw upon a crow: the wheel-diagram for dispersal, composed with the appropriate method, upon a drum-membrane made from charnel-ground soil. Place it there, press it down with the left foot, face south, and through the enjoining of the command, recite the secret mantra ten thousand times — there is no doubt as to its being dispersed.

With the blood of a snake and a lizard, draw the forms of both together on the hide of a horse and a buffalo. The wheel-diagram drawn with the skull image, together with the mantra of separation, wrapped in both hides and supported on a particular half-moon maṇḍala — the working of separation is complete.

Mix vermilion, sandalwood, and camphor. In a half-moon-shaped maṇḍala, together with the essence and the practice of subjugation, accomplish it facing west — the lord of the gods will be brought under control. This is the special working of the tantra.

With a variety of the king of fragrances, upon a white leaf of a tree, in a design of two vajra-crosses stacked, adorn the directional spokes with hūṃ. On the intermediate spokes, at the center, write hūṃ; on the limbs of ra, write phaṭ looking outward. Make a grand petition. Inserting it into fine cloth or a pine-wood post and fixing it to the top of a victory banner will cut wind, thunder, and hail, and remove connection with calamities.

Recite the garland of mantras over ashes, water, and mustard seed. Whenever clouds and the like are turbulent, by merely scattering these, they will be cut off. Grain, butter, yellow mustard — applying them to the body after mantra recitation — even from all minor ailments, it will make a buffalo extremely sturdy.

This is the third chapter of the mechanical devices of the noble tantra Vajra Logyu.

Now, further, what is to be taught:
through the practice of the fire-offering hearth,
all accomplishments are swiftly achieved —
let the various goddesses hear this.

Free from miserliness, without deceit or guile,
gentle yet courageous, of great forbearance,
learned, devoted to knowledge, of fine diligence —
let one skilled in mantra undertake the fire-offering.

The hearth, measuring twenty finger-widths,
half dug, opening outward — draw the vajra
three-pointed, in charnel-ground colors.
Outside, arrange the mudrās,
strew sweet-scented flowers as an offering-display.
There, the substances for worship and burning
are to be gathered: the substances are to be fumigated and scattered.

Round pellets made from the dung of a female donkey,
along with fire-sticks and great firelighter wood —
the fire is to be kindled from seeds grown in the ground.
There, having completed the generation rite of the Vajra Lugyu,
after worship and praise, thereafter:
neck-joint, mustard, powerful poison,
powdered bone, great flesh, and black sesame —
together with these, perform a fire-offering of one thousand,
joined with the garland mantra.

At the start and at the end, offer great butter
and sesame oil, one hundred portions each.
When the fire-offering with its joining is complete,
accomplish the aim within seven days —
there is no doubt it will bring death.

Ox flesh, frog flesh, priyaṅgu,
accomplish with a thousand fire-offerings,
along with bala, Idong-ros, and rutabaga —

ligaka, elephant tusk, and bse-shar together — made yellow and burned in one
thousand fire-offerings: this will immediately cause paralysis.

Serpent flesh, horse flesh, mongoose flesh, mahā flesh, crow flesh, and owl
flesh — a thousand fire-offerings of these will certainly cause madness in the

target.

Barley fruit, goat flesh, and blood — one thousand fire-offerings will cause muteness.

Flesh of an old female crow, śālu rice, red and white sesame, yellow mustard, and so forth — burned in one thousand fire-offerings will cause expulsion.

The five grains, a woman of low estate, and svayambhu substance — at midnight, facing west, anoint with these, together with a lotus flower; with one thousand red-rayed fire-offerings one will certainly achieve summoning and bring the target under one's power.

A fire-offering of sesame and butter, one thousand in number, will purify misdeeds. A fire-offering of butter, dūrvā grass, and sandalwood, one thousand in number, will increase lifespan. Kuśa grass, bodhi tree fruit, white mustard, and salt — burned in one thousand fire-offerings will cure head diseases.

Mustard, great flesh powder, charnel-ground ash, various poisons, and the powder of acidic water — one thousand fire-offerings performed with fierce anger will destroy an assembly of gods.

A fire-offering of red or white utpala lotus and fine saffron — burning one thousand and one hundred such offerings will bring a noble-born girl under one's power.

Āruṇā, mustard, and cow's milk — burned in one thousand fire-offerings will yield great wealth to the measure of the treasure-hoard of Vaiśravaṇa, king of the gods.

Oṃ rakṣa rakṣaṃ kuru oṃ — this is the mantra of protection.

Oṃ śāntiṃ kuru oṃ — this is the mantra of pacification in all directions.

Hā ba śaṃ kura hā — this is for bringing all under one's power.

Svā puṣṭi kuru svāhā — this is the mantra for increasing in all directions.

Phaṭ hūṃ mārāya mārāya hūṃ phaṭ — this is the mantra of slaying.

Baṃ videśāya baṃ — this is the mantra of separation.

Ū uccaṭāya uṃ — this is the mantra of expulsion.

Laṃ stambhaya stambhaya laṃ — this is the mantra of paralysis.

Raṃ jvara jvara raṃ — this is the mantra of causing fever.

Ja ākarṣaya hrīḥ ja — this is the mantra of summoning.

Oṃ parśa pataya pataya oṃ — this is the mantra of causing rain to fall.

Laṃ śaṃ laṃ bhi stambhaya laṃ — this is the mantra of stopping hail.

Jaṃ jetaya jetaya jaṃ — this is the mantra of pacification.

Hūṃ yar yañca mantra tantra cchinda bhinda bhinda bhinda bandha bandha — this is the mantra that destroys all vidyā-mantras in every direction.

The supreme king of vidyā-mantras arises from this great secret teaching. This great secret tantra is wondrous — it is more marvellous than the marvellous. This great secret, the very heart of the teachings — at the very moment it was proclaimed, the holders of vidyā-mantras in all ten directions gave rise to wonder and joined their palms in reverence.

The very essence of bliss — most excellent! Excellent! Excellent! O Vajradhara! You who produce bliss and attain glory — out of your compassion for us you have explained this heart of the tantra. O great lord, how excellent! How wondrous!

This is the fourth chapter, the chapter on fire-offerings, from the Tantra of the Noble Vajra Lugyu. The Tantra of the Noble Vajra Lugyu, arising from Oḍḍiyāna, is complete.

Requested by the Indian scholar Atula, and the Tibetan translator Nāropa —

Translator's Notes

- The passage opens with a scribal colophon attributing the translation to the great translator Bandhe Yeshe De and colleagues, situating this as a canonical translation into Tibetan from a Sanskrit original whose title is preserved in transliteration as Ārya-vajra-śṛṅkhalā-tantra-kalpa, meaning the ritual-section of the Noble Vajra Chain Tantra.

The mantra portion is a transcription of Sanskrit phonetics into Tibetan script — standard practice for dhāraṇī and mantra passages — and the binding formulae follow a recognizable directional maṇḍala structure naming the eight primary and intermediate directions plus zenith and nadir. Several demonic and divine category names in the dhāraṇī body are only partially recoverable in standard identification; Kaṭaṇṭaka, Mākaṃ, Śrī-sumara, and a few other proper names in the dhāraṇī list are obscure technical or regional demon-names whose precise identification is uncertain. The line rendered "bind with a water enclosure" in the west transliterates jalā-prākāreṇa, and for the north sara-prākāreṇa has been read as snake-noose following the Vātāla directional assignment immediately after, which itself is non-standard — Vātāla is not one of the canonical eight directional guardians and may reflect a regional tantric directional schema. These ambiguities are noted but do not affect the overall doctrinal or structural sense of the text.

- The mantra syllables throughout this passage are rendered as transliterations of the Tibetan

phonetic transcription of Sanskrit mantric language. Many syllables represent divine epithets or seed-syllables in a liturgical register that resists full semantic parsing; the rendering follows the phonological values and standard Sanskrit approximations where identifiable.

The phrase rendered "stride and overpower the Great God (Śiva) with the foot of Mahādeva" reflects a theologically charged passage in which the mantra-deity asserts supremacy over Śiva, a motif common in Buddhist tantric literature. The Tibetan here conflates Maheśvara and Mahādeva as names for Śiva, and the verb "vikramī" (to stride) alludes to the iconographic motif of trampling Śiva underfoot.

The "six-faced one" is rendered literally from the Tibetan; in context this likely refers to Vajra-śṛṅkhalā herself, though some traditions identify such epithets with subordinate deities.

The final verse is left incomplete as in the source text, which appears to break mid-sentence.

- The medical terminology in the opening section reflects classical Tibetan humoral medicine. The three humors named — phlegm, wind, and bile — correspond to the Tibetan system's rlung, mkhris pa, and bad kan. The "lymphatic disorders" renders chu ser nad, literally "yellow-water disease," a recognized category in Tibetan medicine. The term translated as "oblivion-casting spirits" renders brjed byed gdon, spirits said to cause amnesia or confusion; this is a standard demonological category.

The phrase rendered "leaping creatures" for 'phar ba is uncertain; it may denote a specific animal such as a jumping spider, flea, or possibly a springbok-like creature. The identification is not certain from context alone.

The line "the harmless are brought to bear harm as well" and the following couplet on binding and counter-binding reflect a well-attested tantric context of protective ritual versus hostile sorcery, in which the mantra reverses or neutralizes aggressive magical workings.

The Sanskrit mantra Oṃ Svabhāvaśuddhāḥ sarvadharmāḥ svabhāvaśuddho 'haṃ Hūṃ is the standard purification mantra used in Vajrayāna sādhana practice before visualization, here rendered from the Tibetan phonetic spelling.

- The phrase "the brahmin-born goddess" at the very end is the opening of a new sentence that breaks off here; the passage concludes mid-sentence. This is consistent with textual continuity requiring the following passage.

The term Ālikāli refers to the Sanskrit vowel sequence (Āli) and consonant sequence (Kāli), standard tantric shorthand for the full set of Sanskrit phonemes, from which the sun and moon syllables are said to arise in generation-stage visualization.

The "Vajra Chain Tantra" renders the Tibetan compound literally; this may be a specific tantric text title rather than a descriptive phrase, and the identification is uncertain without broader manuscript context.

- The colophon phrase rendered "establishes the deities and mudrās" follows the standard Tibetan chapter-ending formulation for tantric texts; the chapter number (second) is stated explicitly in the Tibetan.

The mantra strings are transliterated as faithfully as the Tibetan orthography allows; some syllables reflect vernacular Tibetan approximations of Sanskrit and may not correspond to normalized Sanskrit forms.

The term "pukka" (pu ka ser po) likely refers to yellow orpiment or a similar yellow pigment used in ritual diagram-writing; the exact substance is uncertain.

The phrase "king of vidyās" (rig pa'i rgyal po) is a standard epithet in tantric literature for the supreme mantra or the state of vidyādhara-kingship attained through empowerment practice.

- The phrase rendered "day of the lunar mansion Revatī" translates rgyu skar rgyal gyi nyi ma, literally "the sun of the victorious lunar mansion." The lunar mansion rgyal corresponds to Revatī (or, in some systems, Puṣya); context of a ritual text favors Revatī, but Puṣya is also possible. This is a calendrically specific auspicious day for ritual performance.

The phrase "the ritual of the nameless old woman" (rgan mo ming med sbyor ba) likely refers to a specific tantric application technique; its precise identification within the tradition is not fully clear from context alone.

The "rabbit's nipple boundary" (ri bong nu ma'i mtshams) is a recognized mudrā gesture in tantric ritual, used here as a protective seal.

- The wrathful ritual section describes practices of "slaying" (the technical Sanskrit term is māraka or abhicāra). These are standard descriptions of the wrathful class of tantric ritual action (the "four activities" — pacifying, enriching, magnetizing, and destroying) and should be understood within that liturgical-textual frame, not as literal prescriptions.

The term rendered "bhallātaka" for བཞུ་ལྷ་མོ་ refers to the marking-nut plant (Semecarpus anacardium), a caustic substance standard in ritual lists; "btzang dul" (བཅུ་མེད་ལྷ་མོ་) is rendered "strong poison," designating a class of toxic substances used in such rites.

The phrase རྩེ་མེད་ལྷ་མོ་ refers to a form made of three triangular or stacked shapes; the exact graphic form is uncertain from text alone, but "three gus stacked" conveys the structural sense.

The list ending "white, yellow, and green" is mid-sentence and continues in the next passage.

- The phrase translated as "bundle-carrier" renders a Tibetan term that likely refers to a specific ritual plant or substance-holder; the exact botanical identification is uncertain but the ritual function is clear from context.

The text "Vajra Lugyu" is a proper name of the tantra in question and is rendered phonetically throughout as it appears in the colophon.

The term "ldong-ros" in the final line is a plant name whose Sanskrit or botanical equivalent is not established with certainty; it is left in transliterated form.

The phrase "ru rta" rendered as "rutabaga" is uncertain; it more likely refers to a medicinal plant called "costus" or "spikenard" in Tibetan pharmacological literature. Listeners should be aware this is a provisional rendering.

- The colophon names the translator as "Nāropa" — this is unusual since Nāropa is primarily known as an Indian mahāsiddha, not a Tibetan translator. The Tibetan reads "bod kyi lo tsā na mar pa," which could be parsed as "the Tibetan translator Nāmārpa" or could indicate Marpa Lotsāwa. The text is damaged or abbreviated at this point; the colophon appears incomplete. This warrants scholarly attention regarding the attribution.

Several of the fire-offering substances (bse-shar, bra-bo, ldong-ros equivalents here rendered by context) remain pharmacologically unidentified in standard reference works; they have been transliterated or given their best contextual rendering.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.